

Rank	Skill/Subject	Commonality	Difficulty	ROI	Primary Roles	Priority Tier	
1	Data Structures & Algorithms	5	4	5	All	Tier 1	
2	Programming (C++/Java/Python)	5	3	5	All	Tier 1	
3	Operating Systems	5	4	5	All	Tier 1	
4	Linux	5	3	5	All	Tier 1	
5	Computer Networks	5	4	5	All	Tier 1	
6	Databases (SQL + NoSQL)	5	3	5	All	Tier 1	
7	Object-Oriented Design & Design Patterns	4	3	4	Software Engineering	Tier 1	
8	System Design	5	5	5	Backend/Infrastructure	Tier 2	
9	Distributed Systems	4	5	5	Backend/Infrastructure	Tier 2	
10	Cloud (AWS/GCP/Azure)	4	3	4	Backend/Infrastructure	Tier 2	
11	Docker & Kubernetes	4	4	4	Backend/Infrastructure	Tier 2	
12	Computer Architecture	4	4	4	Systems/GPU	Tier 2	
13	Probability & Statistics	3	4	4	AI/ML	Tier 3	
14	Linear Algebra	3	4	4	AI/ML	Tier 3	
15	Machine Learning	2	4	4	AI/ML	Tier 3	
16	Deep Learning	2	5	5	AI/ML	Tier 3	
17	Transformers & LLMs	2	5	5	AI/ML	Tier 3	
18	PyTorch/TensorFlow	2	4	4	AI/ML	Tier 3	
19	Cryptography	2	5	4	Security	Tier 3	
20	CUDA/GPU Programming	1	5	5	GPU/HPC	Tier 3	
21	Reverse Engineering	1	5	4	Security	Tier 3	
22	Compiler Design	1	5	4	Compilers	Systems	Tier 3